

Complete End-to-End Configuration & Operations Guide

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1. Architecture & Prerequisites

Oodnexa WhatsApp Live Conversation connects Odoo 19 directly to the official **Meta WhatsApp Cloud API** (Graph API v21.0). Unlike legacy solutions that rely on unofficial web scraping or third-party paid gateways (Twilio, MessageBird, Chat-API), this module uses Meta's official cloud endpoints.

Prerequisite Item	Requirement Specification	Purpose
Odoo Instance	Odoo 19.0 Community or Enterprise	Host ERP running Oodnexa WhatsApp module
Domain with SSL/HTTPS	Valid HTTPS URL (e.g. <code>https://odoo.mycompany.com</code>)	Required by Meta for Webhook real-time delivery
Meta Developer Account	Free registration at <code>developers.facebook.com</code>	Creates the WhatsApp Business App
Meta Business Portfolio	Verified Business Manager account	Manages WABA, Phone numbers, and System Users
Dedicated Phone Number	Clean phone number not registered on regular WhatsApp app	Official WhatsApp Business sending identity

Cost Advantage: Meta provides **1,000 free service conversations per month** for every WhatsApp Business Account. You pay zero middleman subscription fees to third-party providers.

2. Phase 1: Meta Developer & WhatsApp Cloud API Setup

Follow these exact steps in the Meta Developer Console:

1 Create a Meta Developer Account

1. Navigate to <https://developers.facebook.com/> and click **Log In** using your Facebook credentials.
2. If you are new, accept the developer terms to activate your developer profile.

2 Create a Meta Business App

1. In the Meta Developer Dashboard, click the green **Create App** button.
2. Choose **Other** → Click **Next**.
3. Select the App Type as **Business** (this provides access to WhatsApp Business API).
4. Enter your **App Name** (e.g., *Oodnexa ERP WhatsApp*) and select your **Meta Business Portfolio / Account**.
5. Click **Create App**.

3 Add the WhatsApp Product

1. On the App Dashboard product selection screen, locate **WhatsApp**.
2. Click **Set Up**.
3. Meta will initialize a sandbox environment with a test WhatsApp phone number and test recipient phone number for immediate testing.

4 Add Your Real WhatsApp Business Number

1. Under WhatsApp → **API Setup**, scroll down to **Step 5: Add a phone number**.
2. Click **Add Phone Number**.
3. Provide your WhatsApp Business Profile Display Name, Category, and Business Description.
4. Enter your dedicated phone number & choose verification method: **SMS** or **Voice Call**.
5. Enter the 6-digit verification code. Your number is now registered to Meta Cloud API!

Important: If the phone number is currently active on the WhatsApp consumer or WhatsApp Business mobile app on an iPhone or Android phone, you must delete that account from the WhatsApp app first before registering it to the Meta Cloud API.

3. Phase 2: Generating Permanent System User Token

The temporary access token generated in the API Setup tab expires in 24 hours. For production Odoo connectivity, you must create a **Permanent System User Access Token** that never expires.

1 Open Meta Business Manager Settings

1. Navigate to **Meta Business Settings** at <https://business.facebook.com/settings>.
2. Select the Business Account associated with your WhatsApp App.

2 Create a System User

1. In the left navigation menu, go to **Users** → **System Users**.
2. Click **Add**.
3. Set the System User Name (e.g., `oodnexa_odoo_integration`).
4. Set the Role to **Admin**.
5. Click **Create System User**.

3 Assign WhatsApp Assets to the System User

1. Select the new System User and click **Add Assets**.
2. Under **Apps**, select your WhatsApp Meta App and grant **Full Control (Manage App)**.
3. Under **WhatsApp Accounts**, select your WhatsApp Business Account and grant **Full Control (Manage WhatsApp Account)**.
4. Click **Save Changes**.

4 Generate Permanent Token with Required Permissions

1. Click **Generate New Token** next to the System User.
2. Select your WhatsApp App.
3. Set Token Expiration to **Never**.
4. Under Permissions, select the following two critical permissions:
 - `whatsapp_business_management` (Read & manage templates, account info)
 - `whatsapp_business_messaging` (Send & receive messages, media, voice notes)
5. Click **Generate Token**. Copy the token immediately and store it securely.

Security Best Practice: Treat this permanent token like an API password. Odoo encrypts and stores it securely in the database.

4. Phase 3: Inside Odoo 19 Configuration

Now configure the Oodnexus WhatsApp integration inside your Odoo backend:

1 Navigate to WhatsApp Providers

In Odoo, navigate to: **WhatsApp** → **Configuration** → **Providers**.

Open the pre-configured provider or click **New**.

2 Enter Meta Credentials into Odoo

Fill out the provider form with the credentials obtained from the Meta Developer Console:

Odoo Field Name	Value from Meta Console	Example / Format
Provider Name	Friendly identification label	Meta WhatsApp Business
Phone Number ID	API Setup → Phone number ID	123456789012345 (numeric ID)
WABA ID	WhatsApp Business Account ID	waba-01234567890123
Permanent Access Token	Permanent System User Token	EAAB... (starts with EAAB)
Account Mode	Production / Sandbox toggle	Select <i>Production</i> for live operations

3 Test Connection

1. Click the **Test Connection** button at the top of the provider form.
2. Odoo performs an instant handshake with Meta Graph API v21.0.
3. If credentials are correct, a green banner appears: **"Connected / Verified"** along with your verified WhatsApp Business display name and Quality Rating (Green / High).

5. Phase 4: Webhook Configuration for 2-Way Live Chat

Webhooks enable real-time two-way messaging: when a customer sends a WhatsApp text, audio voice note, or photo, Meta immediately notifies Odoo via webhook.

1 Copy Webhook Details from Odoo

On your Odoo WhatsApp Provider record, locate the **Webhook Configuration** section:

- **Callback URL:** `https://your-odoo-domain.com/whatsapp/webhook/[token]`
- **Verify Token:** A secure unique random string generated by Odoo.

2 Configure Webhook in Meta Developer Console

1. In the Meta Developer Portal, go to **WhatsApp** → **Configuration**.
2. Locate the **Webhook** section and click **Edit**.
3. Paste the **Callback URL** copied from Odoo.
4. Paste the **Verify Token** copied from Odoo.
5. Click **Verify and Save**. Meta will send a verification ping to Odoo. Once validated, a green checkmark will appear.

3 Subscribe to Webhook Event Fields

1. Under the Webhook section in Meta, click **Manage Webhook fields**.
2. Find `messages` and click **Subscribe**.
3. (Optional) Subscribe to `message_template_status_update` for instant template approvals.
4. Click **Done**.

SSL Requirement: Meta will refuse Webhook URLs that use HTTP or self-signed SSL certificates. Your Odoo instance must have a trusted SSL certificate (e.g., Let's Encrypt, Cloudflare, or standard CA certificate).

6. Phase 5: Using WhatsApp Live Chat & 1-Click Quotations

With your Meta integration and Webhook configured, your team can begin managing customer conversations inside Odoo.

1 Launching Split-Screen Live Console

1. In the Odoo main navigation, go to **WhatsApp** → **Messages** → **Live Conversations**.
2. The console opens in a full split-screen layout:
 - **Left Pane (Conversation Drawer):** Displays all active customer chats, customer name, avatar initials, phone number, timestamp of latest message, and green unread count pills.
 - **Center Pane (Message Thread):** WhatsApp message history, incoming/outgoing bubbles, status indicators (Sent, Delivered, Read), voice note player, and input bar.
 - **Right Pane (Customer Profile):** Linked Odoo Partner card, contact details, and quick action buttons.

2 1-Click Quotation Creation from Active Chat

During an active conversation with a potential buyer:

1. Click the green **"CREATE QUOTATION"** button on the top-right action bar.
2. Odoo automatically opens the Sales Quotation modal with the customer already pre-filled.
3. Add product order lines, quantities, and pricing.
4. Click **"Confirm & Send WhatsApp Quotation"**.
5. Odoo immediately generates the official Quotation PDF, confirms the order, and dispatches the quote summary with downloadable link/PDF back to the customer's WhatsApp chat thread!

3 Inbox Filter Tabs & Real-Time Search

Quickly organize customer chats using the top filter pills:

- **All:** Shows all active customer discussions.
- **Unread:** Filters down to customers awaiting an agent response.
- **My Messages:** Shows conversations specifically assigned to the logged-in agent.
- **Search Bar:** Real-time filtering by customer name, phone number, or message text.

7. Phase 6: Voice Notes, Media & Mobile Responsive Usage

1 Recording & Sending Live Voice Notes

Give customers a personal touch by sending authentic voice messages:

1. In the bottom reply bar, click the **Microphone icon**.
2. Allow microphone access in your browser when prompted.
3. A recording timer will begin counting (e.g. `00:15`).
4. Click the **Send button** (green check) to immediately encode and send the audio note, or click the red **Cancel button** to discard.
5. The voice note appears as a native WhatsApp audio player with a play/pause button, scrubber, and waveform!

2 Transmitting Videos, Images & Documents

Click the **Paperclip (Attach)** icon to send rich media:

- **Images (JPG, PNG, WEBP):** Transmitted with interactive lightbox viewer.
- **Videos (MP4, 3GP):** Plays natively inside WhatsApp on mobile.
- **PDF Documents:** Send brochures, technical specification sheets, and contracts.

3 Mobile & Tablet Responsive Operations

Oodnexa WhatsApp Live Conversation is engineered with a mobile-first philosophy:

- On mobile smartphones (< 992px), the console intelligently presents a single-pane interface.
- Tap any customer to slide into the chat thread.
- Tap the back arrow ← to return to the conversation list.
- The mobile voice recorder and camera upload buttons are thumb-friendly for fast field operations.

8. Phase 7: Automations, Troubleshooting & Meta FAQ

The 24-Hour Customer Service Window (Crucial Meta Policy)

Meta enforces a **24-hour customer service window**:

- **Within 24 Hours of Customer's Last Message:** You can send any free-form text, voice note, quotation, image, or video with zero restrictions.
- **After 24 Hours:** To re-engage a customer who has been inactive for over 24 hours, you must use an **Approved WhatsApp Message Template** (HSM). Once the customer replies, a new 24-hour free-form session begins.

Troubleshooting Matrix

Symptom	Root Cause	Resolution
Error: (#190) Invalid OAuth Access Token	Temporary token expired or invalid permissions	Generate a Permanent System User Token with <code>whatsapp_business_messaging</code> and expiration set to <i>Never</i> .
Outgoing message status stuck on 'failed'	Recipient phone number missing international country code	Ensure customer phone numbers include country code without symbols (e.g. <code>+966501234567</code> or <code>966501234567</code>).
Incoming messages not appearing in Odoo	Webhook URL not verified or 'messages' field not subscribed	Check Meta Developer Console → WhatsApp → Configuration → Webhook. Confirm green verified check and subscription to <code>messages</code> .
Microphone voice recording not starting	Browser microphone permissions blocked	Click the padlock icon next to your browser address bar → set Microphone to <i>Allow</i> .

Need Assistance? Our certified Odoo integration team at **Oodnexa Technologies** is available to provide setup assistance, custom workflow rules, and enterprise support.

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